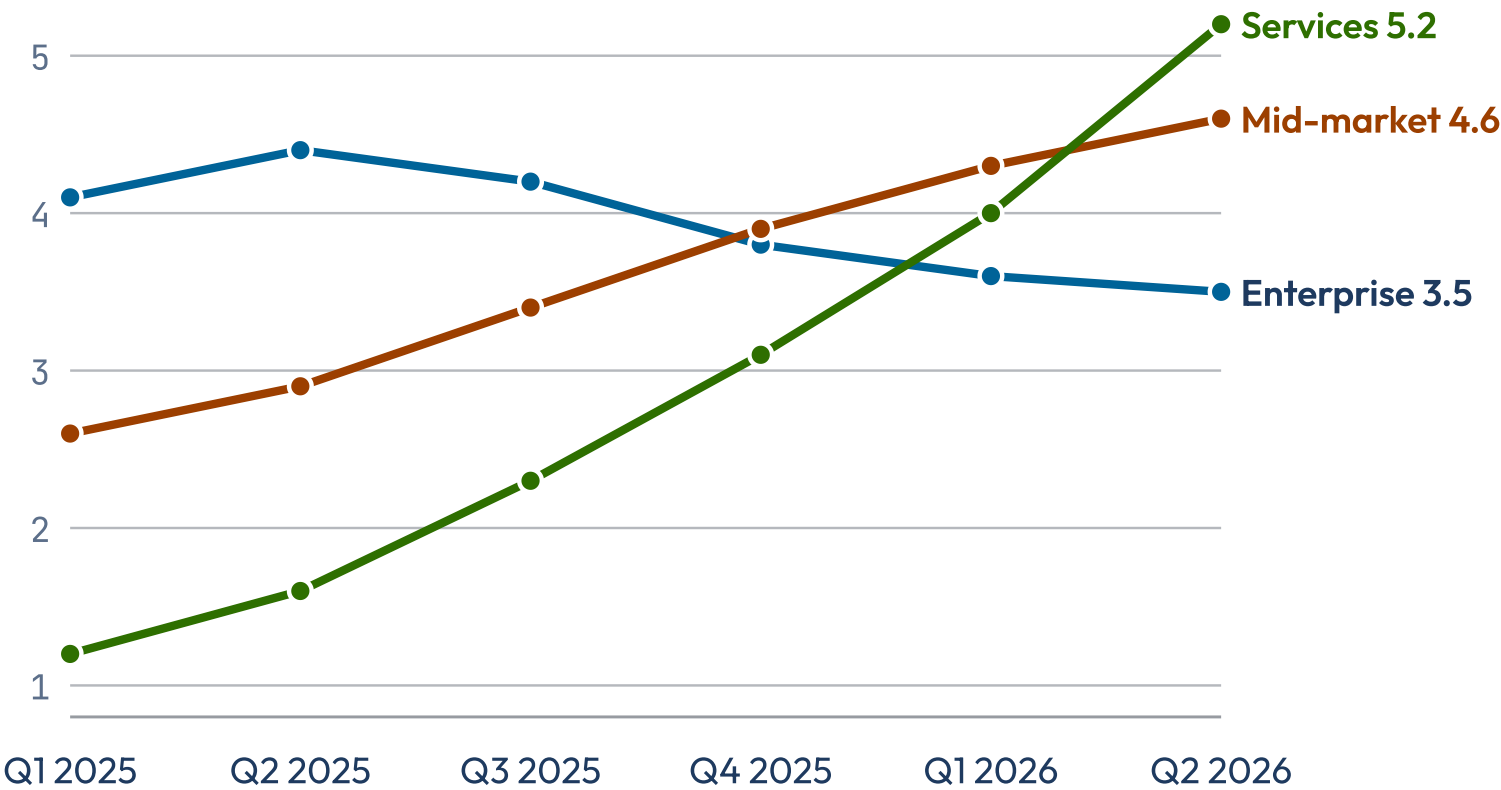


EVIDENCE · CANVAS · SERIES

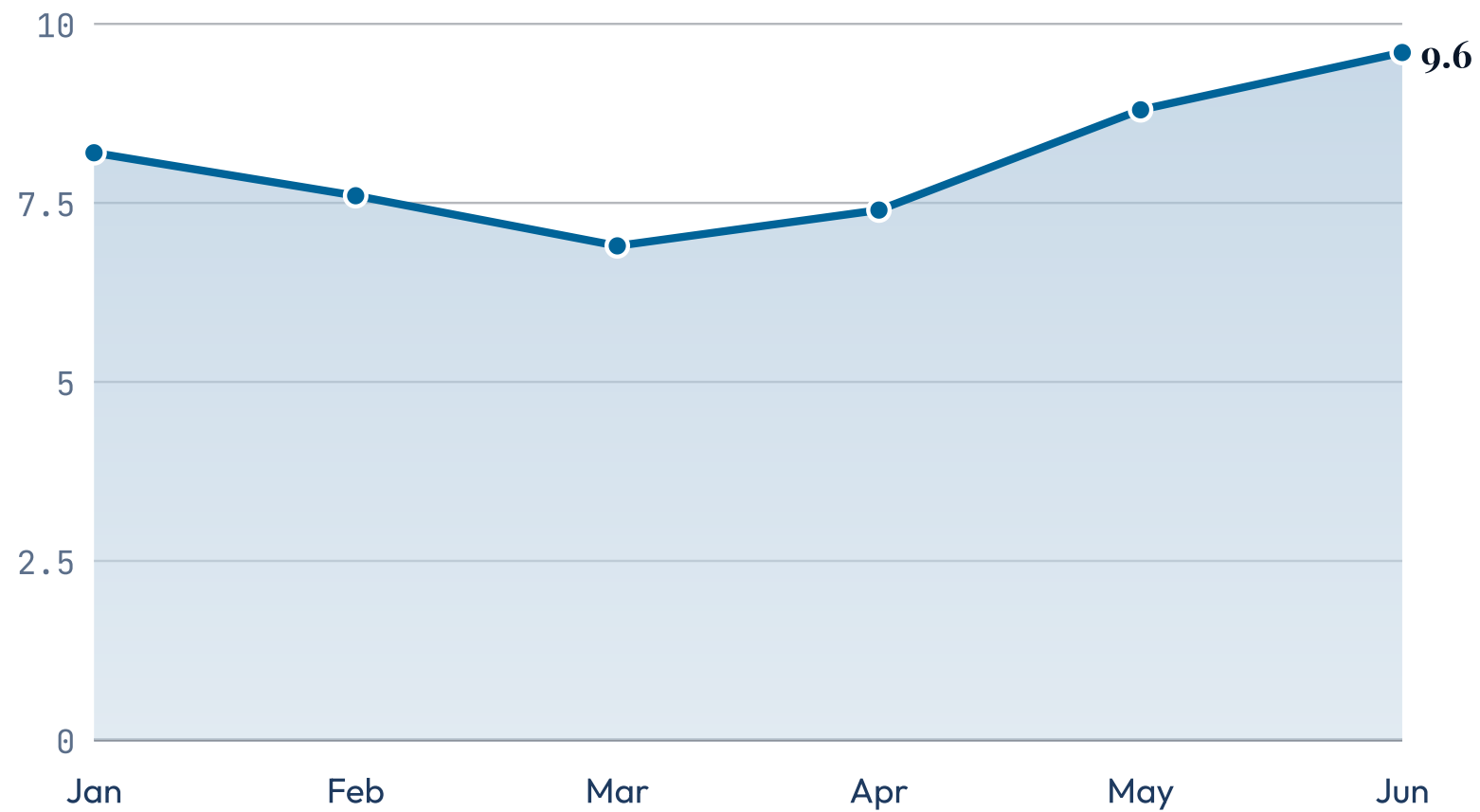
line

A measure plotted across an ordered axis, so the movement is the read — one line or several, optionally filled, stacked, or stepped.

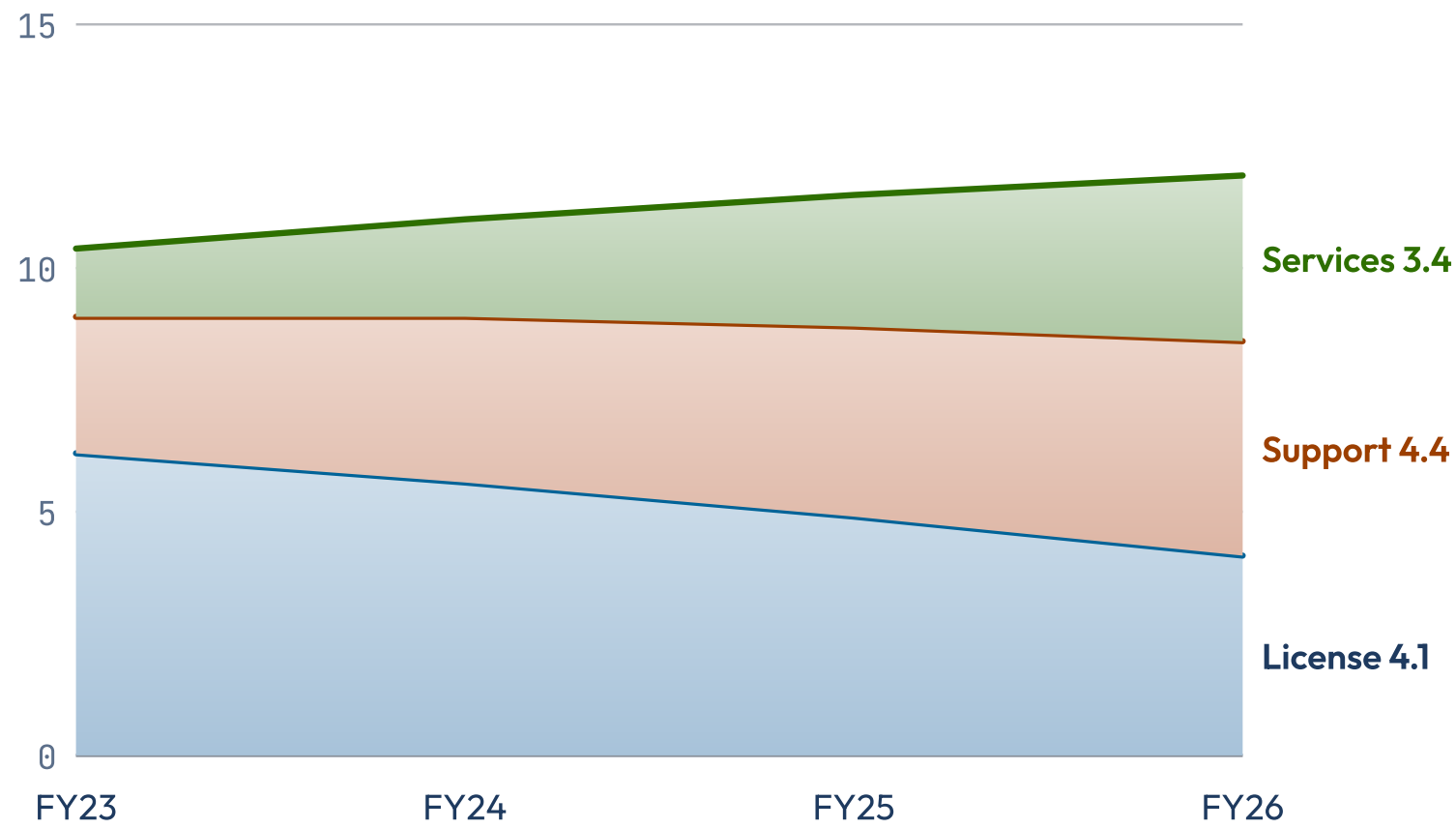
Services grew into the gap enterprise left.



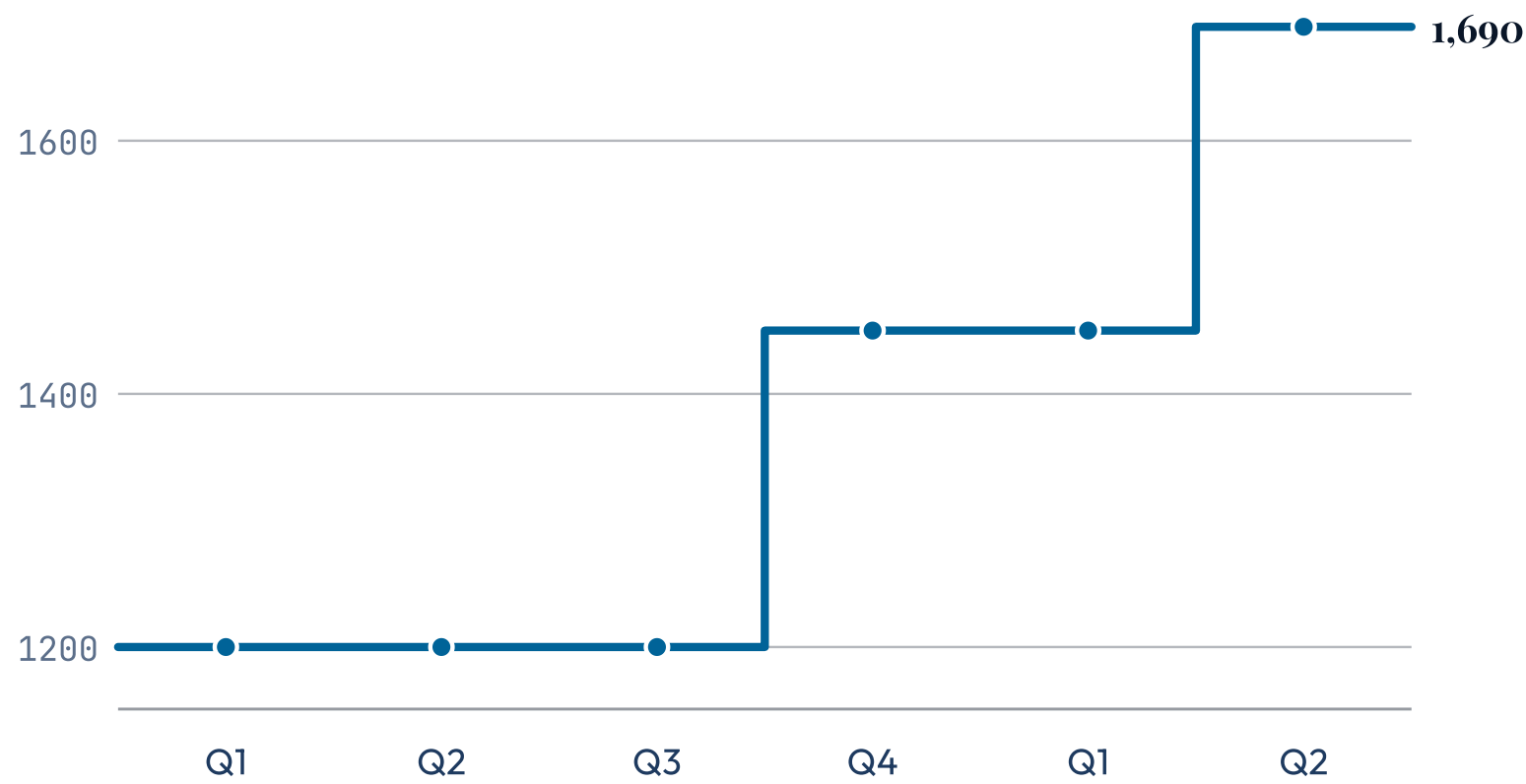
Cash on hand never dipped below one quarter of runway.



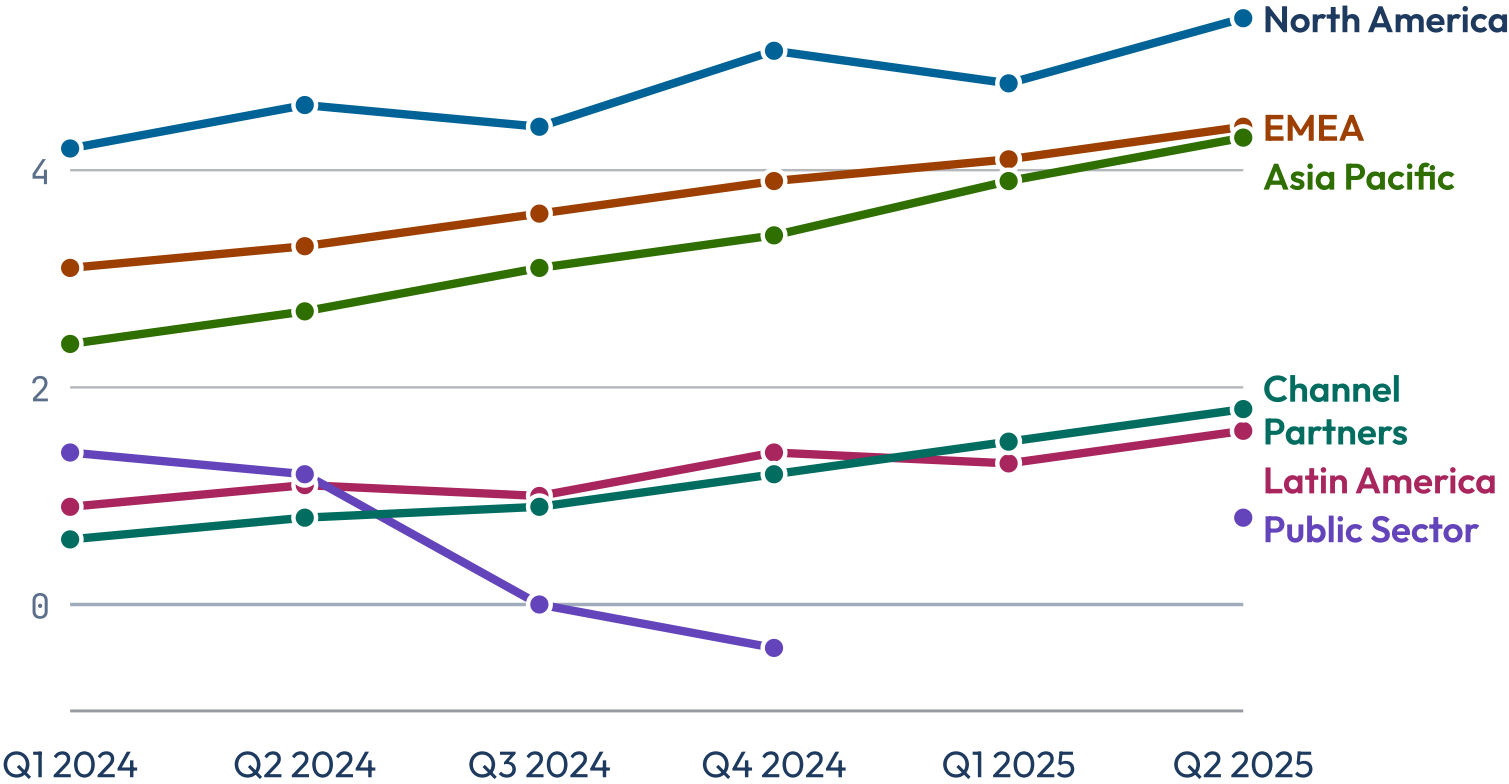
The mix shifted; the total barely moved.



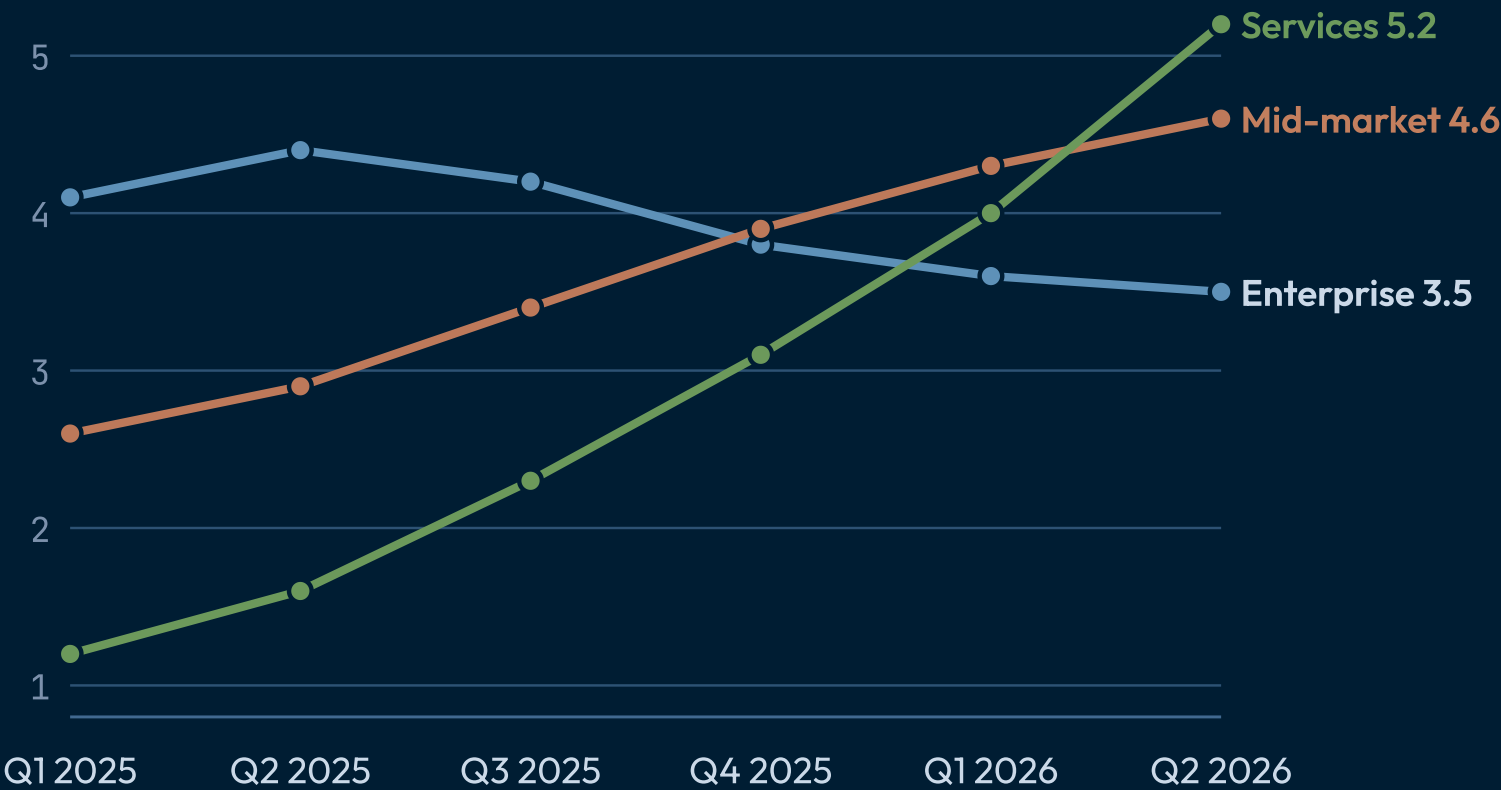
The list price held for three quarters, then moved twice.



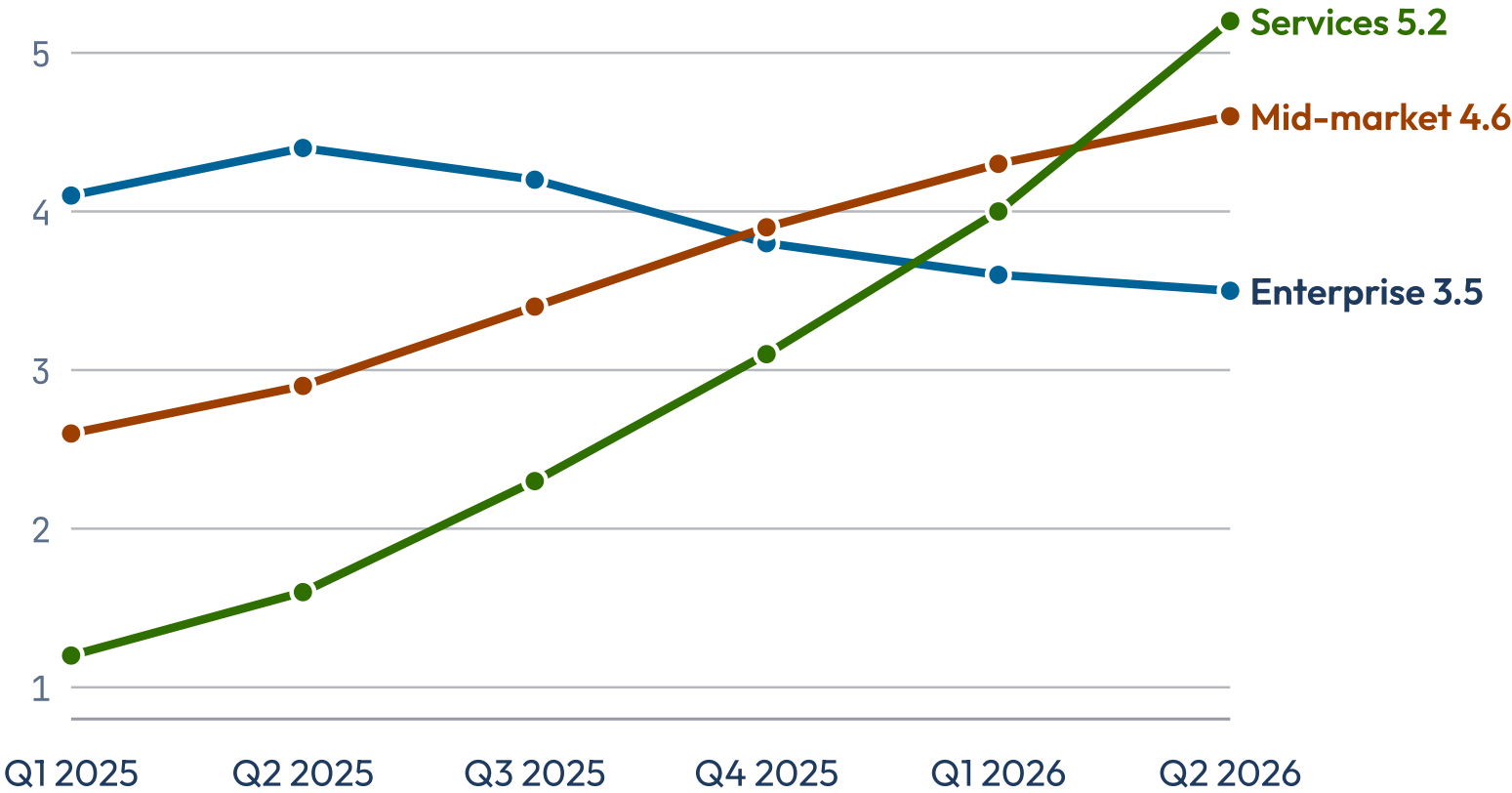
Six lines, twelve quarters, one hole and one loss.



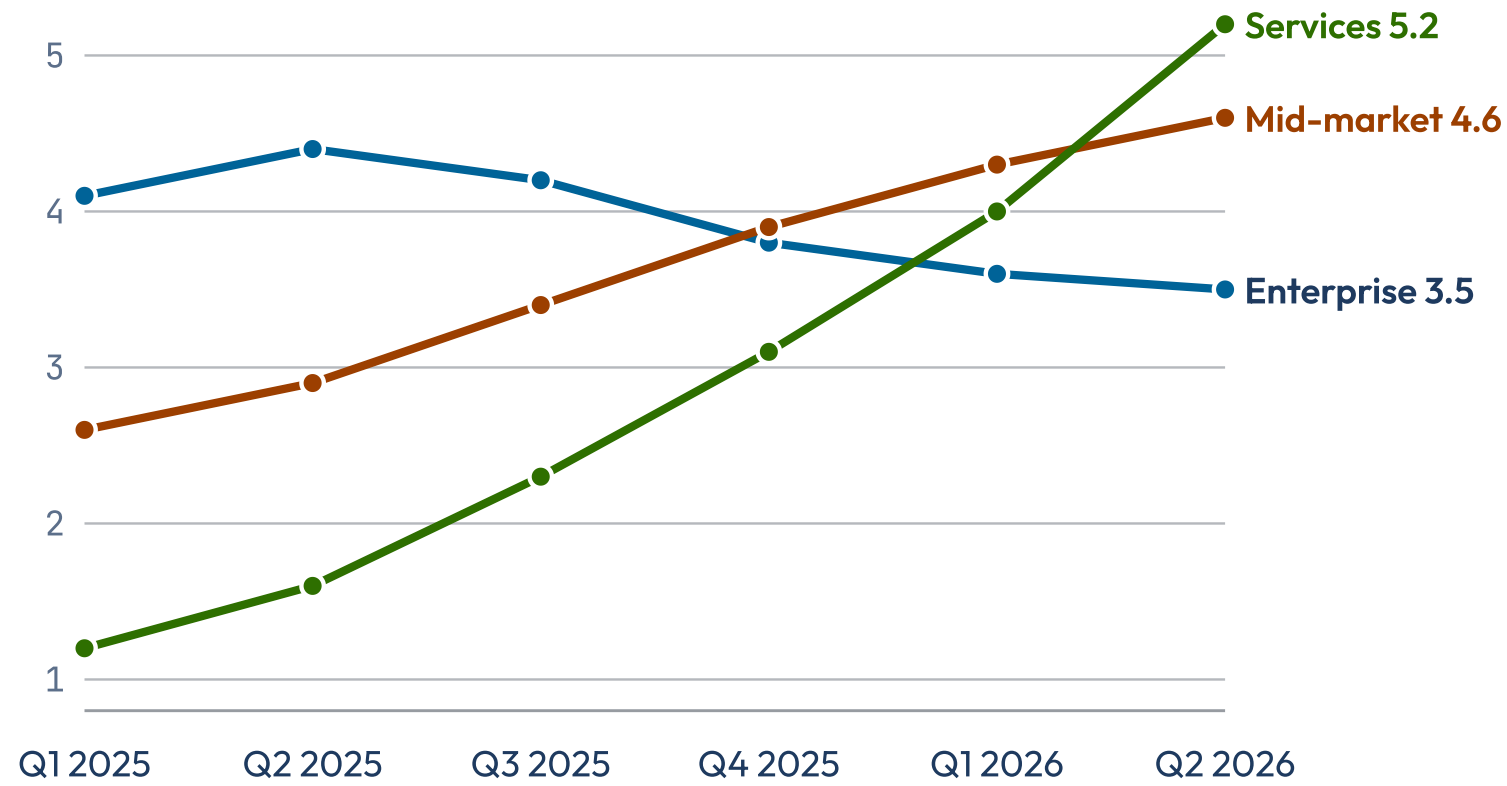
Services grew into the gap enterprise left.



Services grew into the gap enterprise left.



Services grew into the gap enterprise left.



When NOT to reach for line.

Two points

A line between two points is a slope, and a slope chart is a better drawing of it: `slope` puts the entity names at both ends and makes the crossing — who overtook whom — the read. A two-point line chart spends a whole axis on one comparison.

Categories that are not ordered

Joining 'Legal · Finance · Sales · Ops' with a line asserts a progression between departments that does not exist. Use `bar` for magnitude across unordered categories and `stacked-bar` when each one decomposes.

A filled area for several series

Two opaque regions on one plot hide each other, and the one drawn last wins. Use `stacked-area` when the series genuinely sum to a total, and plain `line` when they do not — the kernel drops the fill by itself rather than draw the lie.

A trend where the story is attainment against a target

If the question is 'did we hit the number', the line is the wrong furniture — the target is not on it. `bullet` puts actual, target and a qualitative band on one row; `progress` shows plain attainment.

See also.

`bar` — the categories are unordered and the claim is magnitude, not movement

`slope` — there are exactly two points and the story is which entities changed rank

`stacked-bar` — each period decomposes into parts and the periods are compared, not connected

`bullet` — the number is read against a target and a qualitative band, not against its own past

`gantt` — the horizontal axis is real dates carrying durations rather than an ordered set of measurements